

FROM ZERO TO PRO

The Complete Beginner's Guide to Building &
Hosting Your Website FREE Using AI

Using Manus AI • GitHub Pages • Netlify • Vercel • and more

40 Pages • Step-by-Step • No Coding Required • Zero Experience Needed

Includes: Real Examples • Screenshots Guide • Troubleshooting • Pro Tips

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CHAPTER

Introduction: You CAN Build a Website

If you are reading this guide, you probably want to build a website but feel scared because you think it requires coding, design skills, or expensive software. Here is the truth: in 2024 and 2025, artificial intelligence (AI) tools have completely changed the game. You can now describe what you want in plain, everyday language — and the AI builds the entire website for you. For free.

This guide was written for people with absolutely zero experience. Whether you have never touched a computer beyond Facebook or WhatsApp, or whether you have tried to build a website before and gave up — this guide will take you all the way from nothing to a real, live website that anyone in the world can visit.

What You Will Have at the End of This Guide

- A fully designed, working website live on the internet
- A free custom web address (domain) connected to your site
- Your site visible on Google search
- The ability to update your site yourself anytime
- Confidence to build more websites in the future

What You Do NOT Need

- No coding knowledge — none at all
- No design experience
- No money — everything in this guide is 100% free
- No technical background
- No previous website experience

■ **IMPORTANT:** Read this guide from start to finish the first time. Then go back and follow each step with your computer open in front of you. Do not skip chapters — each one builds on the previous.

CHAPTER 1

Understanding What a Website Is

Before we build anything, let us make sure you understand what a website actually is. Do not worry — this will only take a few minutes and it will make everything else in this guide much clearer.

Think of a Website Like a Shop

Imagine you want to open a shop. You need three things: a building to put your products in, a street address so people can find you, and someone to keep the lights on so the shop stays open 24 hours a day. A website works exactly the same way.

Shop World	Website World	What It Means
The building	Your website files	HTML, CSS, images stored on a computer
The street address	Your domain name	e.g. www.yourname.com
The landlord keeping lights on	Web hosting	A company's server keeping your site online 24/7

The Three Parts of Every Website

1. The Files (Your Website Content)

Every website is made up of files — like documents on your computer. These files contain your text, images, colours, and layout. In old-school web building, a person had to write these files by hand using code. Today, AI writes all of these files for you automatically.

2. The Domain Name

A domain is your website's address on the internet, like www.habeshacelebrationevents.com. People type this into their browser to visit your site. Domain names can be purchased (usually \$10–\$15 per year) but there are also free options we will cover in this guide.

3. The Hosting

Hosting is a service where your website files live on a powerful computer (called a server) that is always on and connected to the internet. When someone types your domain name, their browser connects to this server and downloads your website files to display on their screen. FREE hosting services like Netlify, GitHub Pages, and Vercel exist and work extremely well for most websites.

■ **TIP:** *You do not need to understand every technical detail. Just remember: Files + Domain + Hosting = Website. The AI tools in this guide handle the Files part. We will show you how to handle Domain and Hosting for free.*

CHAPTER 2

Choosing the Right Free AI Tool

There are several AI tools that can build a website for you. This chapter explains each one so you can choose the best one for your situation. All of the tools listed here have a free plan that is good enough to build and launch a real website.

Manus AI

manus.im

BEST FOR BEGINNERS

Manus AI is a fully autonomous AI agent. You simply describe what you want, and it writes all the code, creates the file structure, and delivers a complete, downloadable website. It handles React, HTML, CSS, and even complex multi-page sites. You do not see any code unless you want to. This is the primary tool used throughout this guide.

v0 by Vercel

v0.dev

BEST FOR COMPONENTS

v0 is made by Vercel and specialises in generating beautiful UI components and pages. It is excellent for modern, clean designs. You describe a page and it generates it instantly. Free tier is generous. Slightly more technical than Manus AI.

Bolt.new

bolt.new

GREAT ALTERNATIVE

Bolt.new is a full AI coding environment in your browser. You describe your app or website and it builds it in real time. Very powerful, supports full-stack applications. Free tier has usage limits but is excellent for smaller sites.

Lovable

lovable.dev

GREAT FOR APPS

Lovable is focused on building web applications. It is great if your website needs features like forms, databases, or user login. Slightly more advanced use case but still beginner-friendly with its chat interface.

Google Sites

sites.google.com

SIMPLEST OPTION

If you want the absolute simplest option with zero technical steps, Google Sites lets you drag and drop a basic website. No AI generation, but extremely easy. Best for very simple informational pages.

■ **IMPORTANT:** Throughout this guide we use Manus AI as our primary example because it is the most beginner-friendly and produces complete websites. However, every hosting and deployment step works exactly the same no matter which AI builder you use.

CHAPTER 3

Getting Started With Manus AI — Account Setup

This chapter walks you through creating your Manus AI account step by step. Every single click is explained. Take your time — there is no rush.

1 Step 1: Open Your Web Browser

On your computer, open Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, Microsoft Edge, or Safari. Any of these work perfectly. If you are on a phone, use the browser that comes with your phone.

2 Step 2: Go to the Manus AI Website

In the address bar at the top of your browser (the long white box where you normally type web addresses), type exactly this: `manus.im` — then press the Enter key on your keyboard. You will land on the Manus AI homepage.

3 Step 3: Click 'Sign Up' or 'Get Started'

Look for a button that says 'Sign Up', 'Get Started', or 'Try Free'. It is usually a green or blue button. Click it once with your mouse or tap it on your phone.

4 Step 4: Create Your Account

You will see a registration form. You have two options: sign up with your Google account (easiest — just click the Google button and log in) or sign up with your email address. If using email, type your email address, create a password (make it at least 8 characters with letters and numbers), and click the Create Account button.

5 Step 5: Verify Your Email

If you signed up with email, Manus AI will send a verification email to your inbox. Open your email, find the email from Manus AI (check your Spam folder if you do not see it within 2 minutes), and click the verification link inside it.

6 Step 6: Log In to Your Dashboard

After verifying, you will be logged in automatically or taken to a login page. Enter your email and password and click Log In. You will now see your Manus AI dashboard — a clean page where you can start new projects.

7 Step 7: Explore the Free Plan Limits

Manus AI has a free plan that gives you a certain number of credits per month. Each task you give the AI uses some credits. For a complete website, you will typically use between 20–50 credits. The free plan usually gives you 1000 credits per month, which is more than enough to build and refine a full website.

You Are Ready!

- ✓ You are now inside Manus AI
- ✓ Your account is free — no credit card needed
- ✓ You get enough free credits to build a complete website
- ✓ Your work is automatically saved in the cloud

Understanding the Manus AI Interface

When you log in, you will see a large text box in the middle of the screen. This is where you talk to the AI. Think of it like a WhatsApp message — you type what you want, press Enter or click the Send button, and the AI starts working. On the left side, you will see a list of your previous projects. At the top, you might see a credit counter showing how many credits you have left.

■ **TIP:** *Bookmark the Manus AI website in your browser so you can easily come back to it. In Chrome, press Ctrl+D (Windows) or Cmd+D (Mac) to bookmark the current page.*

CHAPTER 4

Describing Your Website to the AI (Prompt Writing)

This is the most important chapter in the entire guide. The quality of your website depends almost entirely on how well you describe it to the AI. This is called writing a 'prompt'. A prompt is simply a message that explains what you want.

The Golden Rule of AI Prompts

More detail = better results. A vague instruction gives a vague website. A specific, detailed instruction gives a professional website. Compare these two prompts:

BAD PROMPT (Too Vague)	GOOD PROMPT (Detailed)
Make me a website for my event business.	Create a professional 5-page website for an Ethiopian wedding and event planning business called 'Habesha Celebration Events' based in Johannesburg, South Africa. The website should include: a Home page with a hero section, a Services page listing wedding planning, birthday events, and corporate functions, an About page with our story, a Gallery page with placeholder images, and a Contact page with a form. Use an elegant colour scheme of deep green (#1B5E20) and gold (#F4A21E). The font should be clean and modern. Include a navigation bar at the top and a footer with contact details and social media links.

The 8-Part Prompt Formula

Use this formula every time you build a website with AI. Fill in each part for your own business or project:

1. Business/Project Name	What is the exact name of your business, blog, or project?	<i>e.g. Habesha Celebration Events</i>
2. Type of Website	What kind of site is this? Portfolio, business, blog, online store, event site?	<i>e.g. Professional event planning business website</i>
3. Location	Where is your business based? This helps the AI write appropriate local content.	<i>e.g. Johannesburg, South Africa</i>
4. Pages Needed	List every page you want. Be specific.	<i>e.g. Home, Services, About Us, Gallery, Testimonials, Contact</i>

5. Colour Scheme	List your brand colours, or describe the feeling you want.	<i>e.g. Deep green and gold, elegant and luxurious</i>
6. Features	What should the site actually DO? Forms, maps, image galleries, etc.	<i>e.g. Contact form, WhatsApp button, image gallery, Google Maps</i>
7. Content	What text should appear? Give the AI as much real content as possible.	<i>e.g. Include our services: weddings, birthdays, corporate events. Phone: +27 xx xxx xxxx</i>
8. Style Reference	Describe the visual style or name a website that looks similar to what you want.	<i>e.g. Clean, modern, professional — similar to a luxury hotel website</i>

Full Example Prompt You Can Copy and Edit

Here is a complete, ready-to-use prompt. Replace the parts in [BRACKETS] with your own details:

Create a professional website for [YOUR BUSINESS NAME], a [TYPE OF BUSINESS] based in [YOUR CITY], [YOUR COUNTRY]. PAGES REQUIRED: - Home page: Hero section with headline '[YOUR TAGLINE]', a brief intro paragraph, and a 'Contact Us' call-to-action button - Services page: List of services including [SERVICE 1], [SERVICE 2], [SERVICE 3] - About page: Our story, team section with placeholder photos - Gallery page: Image gallery with 12 placeholder images in a grid layout - Contact page: Contact form (name, email, phone, message), our address, phone number, email, and embedded Google Map DESIGN: - Colour scheme: Primary [COLOUR 1], accent [COLOUR 2], background white - Font: Clean, modern sans-serif - Style: Professional, elegant, trustworthy FEATURES: - Fixed navigation bar at top - Mobile-responsive (works on phones) - WhatsApp chat button floating on bottom right - Footer with logo, quick links, contact info, social media icons TECHNOLOGY: Build using React with Tailwind CSS for styling. Make it production-ready and downloadable as a zip file.

■ **TIP:** Do not worry about writing perfect English. The AI understands even if your grammar is not perfect. Just include as many specific details as possible.

CHAPTER 5

Reviewing and Customising Your AI-Generated Website

After you send your prompt to Manus AI, the AI will start building your website. This typically takes between 3 and 10 minutes. During this time, you will see the AI working — it writes code, creates files, and organises everything. You can watch the progress in real time. Here is what to do once it finishes.

How to Preview Your Website

When Manus AI finishes, it will show you a preview of your website directly in the browser. Click on the preview to interact with it — you can click navigation links, scroll through pages, and check how everything looks. This is your first look at your new website.

What to Check in Your Preview

- Navigation works — clicking menu items takes you to the right pages
- All text is correct and makes sense (the AI sometimes writes placeholder text)
- Colours match what you asked for
- The layout looks clean and professional on desktop
- Images appear (they will be placeholders until you add real ones)
- Contact form is present if you requested it
- Footer contains the right information
- The site works on mobile (look for a mobile preview button)

How to Ask the AI to Make Changes

This is the most powerful part of AI website building. If you do not like something, you simply tell the AI what to change — exactly like texting a friend. Here are real examples of change requests you can type:

Change the colour

Type: "Change the navigation bar colour to dark green #1B5E20"

Update text

Type: "On the home page hero section, change the headline to: Johannesburg's Premier Ethiopian Wedding Planner"

Add a section

Type: "Add a testimonials section to the home page with 3 placeholder customer reviews"

Fix layout

Type: "Make the services section display in 3 columns instead of 2"

Add functionality

Type: "Add a WhatsApp button that links to +27 XX XXX XXXX floating on the bottom right"

Change fonts

Type: "Change all headings to use a serif font for a more elegant look"

Add a page

Type: "Add a new page called Packages with pricing tables for 3 packages: Basic, Standard, and Premium"

Replacing Placeholder Content With Your Real Content

AI-generated websites use placeholder text (like 'Lorem Ipsum') and stock images. Before you launch your site, you need to replace these with your real content. There are two ways to do this:

Method 1: Ask the AI to Replace Text

Simply type your request. For example: 'Replace the placeholder about text with this real content: [paste your real text here]'. The AI will update the code automatically.

Method 2: Edit the Files Directly

After downloading your files (covered in the next chapter), you can open the text files and edit the content manually using a free tool like Visual Studio Code or even Notepad. This gives you full control but requires slightly more confidence.

■ **TIP:** Do all your changes and refinements *BEFORE* downloading. It is much easier to make changes inside Manus AI than after downloading. Spend 20–30 minutes getting the preview exactly right.

CHAPTER 6

Downloading Your Website Files

Once you are happy with your website preview, it is time to download the files to your computer. These files are what you will upload to your hosting service to make your site live on the internet.

What Are Website Files?

Your AI-built website is made up of many files that work together. Think of them like the parts of a book — there is the cover, the chapters, the index, and the images. Common file types you will see include:

- **.html files** — These contain the structure of your web pages — the text and layout
- **.css files** — These control the styling — colours, fonts, sizes
- **.js files** — These add interactivity — buttons, animations, menus
- **.jsx or .tsx** — These are React component files (modern websites use these)
- **package.json** — This file tells Node.js what tools your website needs
- **/public folder** — This folder contains your images and other media files
- **/src folder** — This folder contains your main website code
- **/dist or /build folder** — This is the final, ready-to-upload version of your site

How to Download From Manus AI

1 Step 1: Find the Download Button

In Manus AI, after your website is built, look for a button that says 'Download', 'Export', or a zip file icon. It is usually in the top right corner of the project view or in a menu.

2 Step 2: Click Download as ZIP

Click the download button. Manus AI will package all your website files into a single ZIP file and download it to your computer. This file will have a name like 'project.zip' or the name you gave your project.

3 Step 3: Locate the ZIP File

On your computer, open your Downloads folder (on Windows: open File Explorer, click 'Downloads' on the left side. On Mac: open Finder, click 'Downloads'). You will see the ZIP file Manus AI downloaded.

4 Step 4: Extract the ZIP File

Right-click the ZIP file and select 'Extract All' (Windows) or double-click it (Mac). Choose a location to extract to — your Desktop is fine for now. Click Extract. A new folder will appear with all your website files inside.

5 Step 5: Open the Folder

Open the extracted folder. You should see files and subfolders. Do not delete or rename any of these files or folders — the website depends on them all working together.

Understanding Build vs. Source Files

If your website uses React (which is what Manus AI typically builds), there is an important distinction to understand. The source files are the original code that the AI wrote. The build files are the final, optimised version ready to be put on the internet. You upload the BUILD files to your hosting, not the source files.

If your downloaded folder contains a folder called 'dist' or 'build' — that is your build folder. If it does not, you may need to run a build command. Do not panic — Chapter 7 on Netlify hosting will show you how to do this with a single drag and drop, no commands needed.

■ **IMPORTANT:** Keep your ZIP file saved somewhere safe on your computer. This is your backup. If something goes wrong with your live website, you can always re-upload from this file.

CHAPTER 7

Free Hosting Option 1 — Netlify (Easiest)

Netlify is the easiest and most beginner-friendly way to put your website on the internet for free. It is what powers `habeshacelebrationplaner.netlify.app` and thousands of other real websites. You can literally drag and drop your website folder onto the Netlify website and it goes live in under 60 seconds.

Why Netlify is the Best Choice for Beginners

- 100% free — no credit card required
- Drag-and-drop deployment (no technical commands needed)
- Your site gets an instant web address: `yoursite.netlify.app`
- Supports React, HTML, and all common website types
- Automatic HTTPS security certificate included free
- You can update your site by dragging a new folder anytime
- Excellent reliability — used by millions of professional websites

Setting Up Netlify — Step by Step

1 Step 1: Create a Free Netlify Account

Open your browser and go to `netlify.com`. Click the 'Sign up' button in the top right corner. You can sign up with GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket, or email. For beginners, signing up with email is simplest. Enter your email, create a password, and click Sign Up. Check your email and click the verification link.

2 Step 2: Skip the Setup Wizard

After signing in, Netlify may show you a setup wizard or questions about your project. You can skip these for now by looking for a 'Skip' link or by navigating directly to your dashboard (the main page with 'Sites' shown).

3 Step 3: Find the Deploy Section

On your Netlify dashboard, look for a section that says 'Sites' or 'Deploy your first project'. You will see a box that says something like 'Drag and drop your site folder here' or 'Want to deploy a new site without connecting to Git?'. This is where you will upload your website.

4 Step 4: Prepare Your Files for Upload

Remember from Chapter 6 that React websites need the 'dist' or 'build' folder specifically. Open your extracted website folder on your computer. Look for a folder called 'dist' — if it exists, you will drag THIS folder (not the whole project folder) to Netlify. If there is no 'dist' folder yet, look for instructions below.

5 Step 5: Drag and Drop Your Folder

Drag your dist folder (or your project folder for plain HTML websites) from your computer directly onto the Netlify deployment area in your browser. Hold your mouse button down, drag the folder over the Netlify drop zone, and release. Netlify will immediately start uploading and deploying your site.

6 Step 6: Wait for Deployment

Netlify will process your files. This usually takes 30–90 seconds. You will see a progress indicator. When it says 'Published' or shows a green checkmark, your site is live on the internet.

7 Step 7: Get Your Live URL

After deployment, Netlify will show you your site's URL. It will look something like: random-words-123.netlify.app. Click this link — your website is now live! Anyone in the world can visit it by typing this address.

8 Step 8: Rename Your Site

The random URL is hard to remember. To change it, go to your site settings in Netlify. Look for 'Site configuration' or 'Domain management'. Click 'Change site name' and type a name you prefer, like yourcompanyname.netlify.app. Click Save.

What to Do If There Is No 'dist' Folder

If your downloaded website from Manus AI does not have a dist folder, it means the React build process has not been run yet. The easiest solution is to let Netlify run the build for you automatically. Instead of dragging a folder, you can connect Netlify to your project in a slightly different way. Do not worry — Chapter 8 and 9 cover alternative methods, and the Netlify documentation at docs.netlify.com has a detailed build configuration guide.

■ **TIP:** After your site is live, bookmark your Netlify dashboard page. Every time you want to update your website, just drag a new dist folder onto the Netlify deploy zone. Your site updates in under a minute.

CHAPTER 8

Free Hosting Option 2 — GitHub Pages

GitHub Pages is another excellent free hosting option. It is made by GitHub — the world's largest platform for storing and sharing code. Many professional developers use GitHub Pages to host their own portfolios and project websites.

What is GitHub?

GitHub is like Google Drive but specifically for website and code files. When you put your website files in GitHub, GitHub Pages can automatically turn those files into a live website. The address will look like: `yourusername.github.io/yourproject`.

Step-by-Step: GitHub Pages Setup

1 Step 1: Create a GitHub Account

Go to github.com in your browser. Click 'Sign up' in the top right. Enter your email address, create a password, and choose a username. Your username will appear in your website URL, so choose something professional if possible (like your business name). Verify your email address.

2 Step 2: Create a New Repository

A repository is like a folder in GitHub for your website files. After logging in, click the green 'New' button or the plus (+) icon at the top right. Name your repository exactly: `yourusername.github.io` (replace 'yourusername' with your actual GitHub username). Check the box 'Add a README file'. Set the repository to 'Public'. Click 'Create repository'.

3 Step 3: Upload Your Website Files

Inside your new repository, click 'Add file' and then 'Upload files'. Drag and drop all the files from your website's dist folder (or your HTML files for a simple site) into the upload area. You can select multiple files at once by pressing Ctrl+A in your file folder then dragging them all.

4 Step 4: Commit (Save) Your Files

After uploading, scroll down to the 'Commit changes' section. You will see a text box with 'Add files via upload' already typed. You can keep this or type something like 'Initial website upload'. Click the green 'Commit changes' button.

5 Step 5: Enable GitHub Pages

Go to your repository's Settings (the gear icon or tab at the top of the repository page). Scroll down the left sidebar and click on 'Pages'. Under 'Branch', select 'main' from the dropdown menu. Click Save.

6

Step 6: Wait for Your Site to Go Live

GitHub will now build and publish your website. This can take 1–5 minutes. When it is ready, you will see a green box at the top of the Pages settings with your live URL: `https://yourusername.github.io`. Click it to see your live website.

7

Step 7: Updating Your Site in Future

To update your site, simply upload new files to the same repository (drag and drop again, then commit). GitHub will automatically update your live site within a minute or two.

GitHub Pages vs Netlify — Which Should You Choose?

Feature	Netlify	GitHub Pages
Ease of use	■■■■■ Easiest	■■■■ Easy
Speed to go live	Under 1 minute	1–5 minutes
Custom domain	Yes, free	Yes, free
React support	Excellent	Good
Best for	Total beginners	Those who learn GitHub

■ **TIP:** *If you are using this guide for the very first time, start with Netlify (Chapter 7). Come back to GitHub Pages once you are more comfortable — knowing both gives you flexibility.*

CHAPTER 9

Free Hosting Option 3 — Vercel

Vercel is the company that makes Next.js (a popular way to build websites) and they offer free hosting that is specifically optimised for React websites — the same type of website Manus AI builds. Vercel is extremely fast and used by many professional companies.

Why Consider Vercel?

- Blazing fast performance — one of the fastest free hosting services available
- Built specifically for React and modern JavaScript websites
- Free plan is very generous with unlimited personal projects
- Automatic deployments — connect once and every update deploys automatically
- Professional features like analytics even on the free plan
- Free SSL certificate and global CDN included

Setting Up Vercel — Step by Step

1 Step 1: Go to Vercel.com

Open your browser and navigate to vercel.com. Click 'Sign Up' in the top right corner. Sign up with your GitHub account (this is the easiest method and connects your projects automatically) or with your email. If you sign up with GitHub, click 'Continue with GitHub' and log in to your GitHub account when prompted.

2 Step 2: Import Your Project

Once logged in, click 'Add New' and then 'Project'. Vercel will show you your GitHub repositories. Find the repository where your website files are stored and click 'Import'. If your files are not on GitHub yet, you will need to upload them to GitHub first (follow Chapter 8 steps 1–4).

3 Step 3: Configure Your Build Settings

Vercel is smart and will usually detect automatically that you have a React project. It will pre-fill the build settings for you. You should see: Framework Preset set to 'Vite' or 'Create React App', Build Command as 'npm run build', and Output Directory as 'dist'. If these are already filled in correctly, you do not need to change anything.

4 Step 4: Click Deploy

Click the big blue 'Deploy' button. Vercel will now install your project's dependencies, run the build process, and publish your site. You will see a live progress log showing every step.

5 Step 5: Visit Your Live Site

After 1–3 minutes, Vercel will show a 'Congratulations!' screen with confetti and your live site URL. It will look like: `yourproject.vercel.app`. Click the URL to see your website live on the internet.

6 Step 6: Set Up Automatic Deployments

The best part of Vercel: every time you push updated files to your GitHub repository, Vercel will automatically detect the change and redeploy your website within minutes. This means updating your site in future is as simple as updating files on GitHub.

Hosting Summary — All Three Options

- ✓ Netlify: Best for drag-and-drop simplicity
- ✓ GitHub Pages: Best for learning proper web workflows
- ✓ Vercel: Best for React performance and auto-deployments
- ✓ All three are 100% FREE for personal and small business websites

CHAPTER 10

Connecting a Free Custom Domain to Your Site

Right now your website has an address like `yoursite.netlify.app` or `yoursite.vercel.app`. This is fine for starting out, but a professional website needs a proper address like `www.yourbusiness.com`. This chapter shows you how to get one — including free options.

Paid Domain Names (Recommended for Businesses)

A professional .com domain costs around R180–R300 per year (approximately \$10–\$15). The most reputable places to buy a domain name are:

- Namecheap (namecheap.com) — often the cheapest option
- Google Domains / Squarespace Domains — simple, reliable
- GoDaddy (godaddy.com) — largest domain registrar globally
- Afrihost (afrihost.com) — South African provider with local support

Free Domain Options

If you are not ready to pay for a domain yet, there are free options:

- Freenom (freenom.com) — offers free .tk, .ml, .ga, .cf, .gq domains
- js.org — free domains for JavaScript projects
- Your hosting subdomain — `yoursite.netlify.app` is already a real web address

Connecting Your Domain to Netlify

1 Step 1: Buy or Access Your Domain

Log in to wherever you bought your domain (Namecheap, GoDaddy, etc.) and navigate to your domain's DNS settings. DNS stands for Domain Name System — think of it as the phone book of the internet that connects your domain name to your website.

2 Step 2: Add Your Domain in Netlify

Log in to Netlify and go to your site. Click 'Domain management' or 'Set up a custom domain'. Type in your domain name (e.g., `www.yourbusiness.com`) and click 'Verify'. Netlify will confirm it does not already exist on their system.

3 Step 3: Get Netlify's Name Servers or DNS Records

Netlify will give you either Name Servers (something like `dns1.p06.nsone.net`) or specific DNS records (A records or CNAME records). Write these down or leave this window open.

4 Step 4: Update Your Domain's DNS Settings

Go back to your domain registrar (Namecheap, GoDaddy, etc.). Find the DNS settings for your domain. If Netlify gave you Name Servers, replace your current name servers with Netlify's name servers. If Netlify gave you an A record or CNAME record, add those records to your DNS settings.

5 Step 5: Wait for DNS Propagation

DNS changes take time to spread across the internet — this is called DNS propagation. It usually takes between 15 minutes and 48 hours (most commonly 1–4 hours). During this time, your domain is connecting to your website. You can check the progress at whatsmydns.net.

6 Step 6: Enable Free HTTPS

After your domain is connected, go back to Netlify's domain settings and click 'Provision certificate' or 'Enable HTTPS'. Netlify will automatically create a free SSL certificate for your domain. This gives your site the padlock icon in the browser and makes it HTTPS instead of HTTP, which is important for trust and Google ranking.

■ **TIP:** *If you are confused by DNS settings, contact your domain registrar's live chat support. They deal with this every day and are usually very helpful at walking beginners through the process.*

CHAPTER 11

Making Your Website Appear on Google (SEO Basics)

Having a live website is great, but if no one can find it, it does not help your business. SEO stands for Search Engine Optimisation. It is the process of making Google (and other search engines) understand what your website is about so it appears when people search for your services.

How Google Finds and Ranks Websites

Google uses automated programs called 'crawlers' or 'bots' that explore the internet 24/7, reading websites and adding them to Google's giant index. When someone searches for 'Ethiopian wedding planner Johannesburg', Google looks through its index and shows the most relevant results. Your job is to make your website as relevant and trustworthy as possible.

Step 1: Submit Your Site to Google Search Console

Google Search Console is a free tool from Google that lets you tell Google your website exists and monitor how it appears in search results. This is the single most important SEO action you can take immediately after launching.

- Go to search.google.com/search-console and sign in with your Google account
- Click 'Add property' and enter your website URL (e.g., <https://www.yourdomain.com>)
- Choose the 'URL prefix' method
- Google will ask you to verify you own the site — follow the instructions to add an HTML tag to your site or upload a verification file
- Once verified, go to 'Sitemaps' in the left menu
- Submit your sitemap URL: typically <https://yoursite.com/sitemap.xml>
- Google will now actively crawl and index your website (takes 1–6 weeks for new sites)

Step 2: On-Page SEO — The Basics

Page Titles

Every page of your website should have a unique, descriptive title. For example: 'Habesha Celebration Events | Ethiopian Wedding Planner in Johannesburg'. Ask the AI to set proper page titles when building your site.

Meta Descriptions

A meta description is a short summary (155 characters) that appears under your site name in Google results. Ask your AI to add unique meta descriptions to every page.

Keywords in Content

Use the words that people actually search for naturally throughout your website text. If people search 'Ethiopian wedding planner South Africa', make sure those words appear in your content.

Image Alt Text

Every image on your site should have a description (called alt text) that tells Google what the image shows. Ask your AI to add alt text to all images.

Headings Structure

Use proper heading levels (H1, H2, H3) on your pages. Your main page headline should be an H1, section titles should be H2, and subsections H3. The AI usually does this correctly.

Mobile Friendly

Google ranks mobile-friendly websites higher. Test your site at search.google.com/test/mobile-friendly to confirm it passes.

Page Load Speed

Faster websites rank higher. Test your speed at pagespeed.insights.google.com. Netlify and Vercel host your site on fast servers, which helps.

Step 3: Google Business Profile (Local SEO)

If you have a physical business location or serve customers in a specific city, create a free Google Business Profile at business.google.com. This gets you listed in Google Maps and the local search results box, which is extremely valuable for service businesses like event planning.

■ **IMPORTANT:** SEO is a long-term game. Do not expect to appear on page 1 of Google within a week. For most new websites, it takes 3–6 months of consistent effort. Focus on creating genuinely useful content and the ranking will come.

CHAPTER 12

Updating Your Website After Launch

Your website is not a one-time project. You will regularly want to update text, add new photos, change prices, add new services, or redesign sections. This chapter explains the workflow for keeping your site fresh and up-to-date.

The Update Workflow (Manus AI + Netlify)

The established workflow used in this guide is straightforward and repeatable:

1 Step 1: Open Your Project in Manus AI

Log back in to manus.im and find your website project. Click on it to open it. You will see your previous work still there, ready to edit.

2 Step 2: Describe Your Changes to the AI

In the chat box, tell the AI exactly what you want to change. Be specific. For example: 'Update the prices on the Services page. Basic package is now R5,000, Standard is R8,500, Premium is R15,000.' Or: 'Add a new section on the home page announcing our upcoming Johannesburg Wedding Expo appearance on 15 March 2025.'

3 Step 3: Review the Changes in Preview

After the AI makes the changes, preview your website to confirm everything looks correct. Check the specific pages you asked to update. If something is not right, ask the AI to fix it.

4 Step 4: Download the Updated ZIP

When satisfied, download your project again as a ZIP file (exactly as you did in Chapter 6). Extract the ZIP on your computer.

5 Step 5: Navigate to the dist Folder

Open the extracted folder and find the dist folder (or run `npm run build` first if needed — see the note below).

6 Step 6: Drag and Drop to Netlify

Go to your Netlify dashboard and find your site. Look for the 'Deploys' section. You will see an area that says 'Need to update your site? Drag and drop your site output folder here'. Drag your dist folder onto this area. Netlify will upload and deploy your updates. Your live site will be updated within 60 seconds.

What If There Is No dist Folder?

If your website is a React/Vite project (which Manus AI typically builds), you may need to run a build command before you see the dist folder. This requires Node.js to be installed on your computer. Here is how to do it:

- Install Node.js: Go to nodejs.org and download the LTS version. Install it like any normal program.
- Open Terminal/Command Prompt: On Windows, press the Windows key, type 'cmd', and press Enter. On Mac, press Cmd+Space, type 'terminal', and press Enter.
- Navigate to your project folder: Type 'cd ' (with a space after cd), then drag your project folder from File Explorer into the terminal window. Press Enter.
- Install dependencies: Type 'npm install' and press Enter. Wait for it to finish (1–3 minutes).
- Build the project: Type 'npm run build' and press Enter. Wait for it to finish.
- Find your dist folder: It will now appear in your project folder. Use this dist folder for Netlify.

How Often Should You Update Your Website?

- Immediately: When your prices, contact details, or services change
- Monthly: Add new photos, update your portfolio/gallery
- Seasonally: Promote upcoming events, seasonal offers
- Yearly: Consider a full design refresh to keep the site feeling modern

■ **TIP:** Create a document on your computer called 'Website Updates.txt' and write down every change you want to make as you think of them. Then batch them all into one update session instead of doing tiny changes one by one.

CHAPTER 13

Troubleshooting Common Problems

Do not panic when things go wrong. Every website builder — beginner and professional alike — runs into problems. This chapter covers the most common issues and exactly how to fix them.

PROBLEM: My website shows a blank white page

SOLUTION: This almost always means you uploaded the wrong folder to Netlify. Make sure you uploaded the 'dist' folder (not the whole project folder, not the 'src' folder). Also check that the dist folder is not empty — if it is, you need to run 'npm run build' first.

PROBLEM: The CSS (styling) is missing — my site looks broken

SOLUTION: This happens when file paths are incorrect. In your Vite project's vite.config.js file, check that 'base' is set correctly. For Netlify deployments, it should be base: '/' (forward slash). Ask the AI: 'Update the vite.config.js file so the base path is correct for Netlify deployment.'

PROBLEM: The Manus AI ran out of credits

SOLUTION: The free plan has monthly credit limits. Wait until your credits reset next month, or create a second free account. You can also switch to a different AI tool (Bolt.new or v0.dev) to continue building. Your downloaded ZIP files contain all your work so far.

PROBLEM: My domain is not connecting to my website

SOLUTION: DNS changes take time (up to 48 hours). Use whatsmydns.net to check if your DNS records have propagated. If it has been more than 48 hours, double-check that you entered the DNS records exactly as Netlify/Vercel specified.

PROBLEM: Google is not indexing my site

SOLUTION: New sites take 1–6 weeks to appear on Google. Make sure you have submitted your sitemap in Google Search Console. Also check that your site does not have a 'noindex' tag in the HTML head section — ask the AI to confirm this is not present.

PROBLEM: The mobile version looks broken

SOLUTION: Go back to Manus AI and describe exactly what looks wrong on mobile. For example: 'On mobile phones, the navigation menu is overlapping the logo. Please fix this.' The AI will update the CSS to fix the responsive layout.

PROBLEM: Images are not showing on the live site

SOLUTION: If images showed in preview but not on the live site, the image files may not have been included in the dist folder build. Make sure your images are in the 'public' folder of your project, not the 'src' folder. Ask the AI to move any images to the correct location.

PROBLEM: I got an error message during Netlify deployment

SOLUTION: Read the error message carefully. Common errors include: 'Command failed' (the build script has an error — ask the AI to fix the error shown), '404 page not found' (add a `_redirects` file to your public folder — ask the AI to create it), and 'Module not found' (a file is missing — ask the AI to fix the import path).

PROBLEM: I cannot remember my account passwords

SOLUTION: Use the 'Forgot Password' link on each platform's login page. Make sure to store your passwords securely — use your phone's built-in password manager or a free tool like Bitwarden.

PROBLEM: The AI misunderstood what I wanted

SOLUTION: Be more specific in your next message. Describe what you see, what you expected, and what the difference is. For example: 'The services section shows icons in a single vertical list. I wanted them in a 3-column grid with cards. Please redesign this section.'

■ **TIP:** When asking for help online, search for your exact error message in quotes on Google. Also, the communities at reddit.com/r/webdev and stackoverflow.com have millions of answered questions for every website problem imaginable.

CHAPTER 14

Other Free AI Website Builders (Alternatives)

While this guide focuses on Manus AI, there are several other excellent free AI website builders worth knowing about. Each has different strengths, and knowing your options means you can always find a tool that fits your specific project.

Bolt.new

bolt.new

Bolt.new is a full-stack AI development environment that runs entirely in your browser. You describe your website or app in natural language and Bolt builds it in real time, showing you the code and preview side by side. It is excellent for more complex websites that need features like databases, user login systems, or API connections. The free tier gives you enough credits to build and iterate on a complete website. Best for: Beginners who want slightly more control over the build process.

v0 by Vercel

v0.dev

v0 is Vercel's AI tool for generating user interface components and full pages. You describe what you want and v0 generates clean, modern React code instantly. It is particularly strong at creating beautiful, professional-looking designs. You can also ask it to improve existing designs. Free tier is generous. Best for: Creating individual pages or components with high design quality.

Lovable.dev

lovable.dev

Lovable positions itself as an AI full-stack engineer. It builds complete web applications from a description, including backend functionality. It integrates with Supabase for databases. If your website needs users to create accounts, submit orders, or store data, Lovable handles this. Best for: Websites that are more like apps — booking systems, e-commerce, membership sites.

Framer AI

framer.com

Framer started as a design tool and added AI capabilities. Its AI can generate entire website designs from a prompt. Framer's hosting is included and the designs are extremely polished and modern. Free plan available. Best for: Businesses where visual design quality is the top priority — photographers, designers, luxury brands.

Wix AI

wix.com

Wix is one of the oldest website builders and has added AI features. Their ADI (Artificial Design Intelligence) asks you questions and builds a complete website. Wix is perhaps the simplest option of all — everything happens in their browser editor with no file downloads required. Free plan available (shows Wix ads and uses a Wix subdomain). Best for: Absolute beginners who want the simplest possible experience.

Hostinger AI Builder

hostinger.com

Hostinger offers an AI website builder that creates a complete site from a description in seconds. It includes hosting on Hostinger's servers. The AI generates the design, layout, and placeholder content. Very beginner-friendly. Free trial available. Best for: Those who want AI generation and hosting in one place.

Durable.co

durable.co

Durable claims to build a complete small business website in 30 seconds using AI. You enter your business type and location, and it generates a full website with images and copy. Very impressive for speed. Free to try, paid plans for custom domains. Best for: Small businesses that want something live extremely quickly.

Quick Comparison Table

Tool	Difficulty	Best For	Free?
Manus AI	★★★★ Easy	Full websites	Yes
Bolt.new	★★★★ Easy	Full stack apps	Yes (limited)
v0.dev	★★★★ Medium	UI components	Yes
Lovable	★★★★ Easy	Web apps	Yes (limited)
Framer	★★★★ Easy	Design-first	Yes
Wix AI	★★★ Easiest	Simple sites	Yes (ads)
Durable	★ Instant	Quick biz sites	Free trial

CHAPTER 15

Your 7-Day Action Plan — From Zero to Live

This chapter gives you a clear daily plan to go from complete beginner to having a live, professional website in just 7 days. Each day has specific tasks with time estimates. You do not need to follow this exactly — move at your own pace.

DAY 1 Learn and Prepare

- Read Chapters 1 and 2 of this guide (30 minutes)
- Write down your website plan: What pages do you need? What content? What colours?
- Collect any text content you want on your site (services, about us, contact details)
- Gather any logo files or images you already have
- Create accounts on Manus AI (manus.im) and Netlify (netlify.com)

DAY 2 Build Your Website With AI

- Read Chapters 3 and 4 of this guide (20 minutes)
- Write your detailed prompt using the 8-Part Prompt Formula
- Submit your prompt to Manus AI and let it build your site
- Review the preview and make a list of changes needed
- Ask the AI to make up to 5 refinements

DAY 3 Refine and Perfect

- Continue refining your site in Manus AI
- Replace placeholder text with your real content
- Check the mobile version and fix any mobile issues
- Verify all navigation links work correctly
- Read Chapter 5 (reviewing and customising)

DAY 4 Download and Deploy

- Read Chapters 6 and 7 of this guide
- Download your website as a ZIP file from Manus AI
- Extract the ZIP on your computer
- Drag and drop to Netlify and get your site live
- Share the Netlify URL with a friend to get feedback

DAY 5 Domain and SEO Setup

- Read Chapters 10 and 11
- Decide on your domain strategy (free Netlify subdomain or purchase a .com)
- Set up Google Search Console for your site
- Submit your sitemap to Google
- Set up a Google Business Profile if you have a local business

DAY 6 Test, Test, Test

- Open your live website on your phone, tablet, and computer
- Ask 3 people to visit your site and give you honest feedback
- Test every single button, link, and form on your site
- Check that your contact details are correct
- Test the site on different browsers (Chrome, Firefox, Safari)

DAY 7 Launch and Promote

- Share your live website on WhatsApp groups and social media
- Add your website URL to all your social media profiles (Instagram, Facebook, etc.)
- Add your website URL to your email signature
- Print business cards with your website address
- Celebrate — you built a real professional website!

CHAPTER BONUS

Glossary — Website Terms for Beginners

Do not let technical words confuse you. Here is a plain-language explanation of every important term used in this guide and that you will encounter when building websites.

AI (Artificial Intelligence)	Computer programs that can understand language and generate text, code, images, and more. In this guide, AI builds your website code from your descriptions.
Backend	The part of a website that works 'behind the scenes' — databases, servers, and logic the user cannot see. Most simple business websites do not need a backend.
Build	The process of converting your source code into the final files that a web browser can display. Usually done with a command like 'npm run build'.
CDN (Content Delivery Network)	A global network of servers that stores copies of your website close to your visitors. Makes your website load faster for people around the world.
CSS	Cascading Style Sheets. The code that controls how your website looks — colours, fonts, sizes, spacing, and layout.
Deploy / Deployment	The act of publishing your website to a hosting server so it is accessible on the internet.
dist folder	Short for 'distribution'. The folder containing the final, built version of your website ready to be uploaded to hosting.
DNS (Domain Name System)	The internet's address book. It connects domain names (like <code>www.yoursite.com</code>) to the actual server where your website files are stored.
Domain Name	Your website's address on the internet. For example: <code>www.yourname.com</code> . Domains are usually rented annually from a domain registrar.
Framework	A collection of pre-written code that gives you a foundation to build websites. React, Vue, and Next.js are popular frameworks.
Frontend	The part of a website that users see and interact with — the visual design, buttons, text, and images.
Git / GitHub	Git is a version control system that tracks changes to your code. GitHub is a website where you can store and share code using Git.
Hosting	A service that stores your website files on a powerful computer (server) that is always connected to the internet.

HTML	HyperText Markup Language. The basic structure of web pages — defines what elements appear (headings, paragraphs, images, links).
HTTP / HTTPS	The protocol used to transfer data between a browser and a website. HTTPS is the secure version (shows a padlock in the browser).
JavaScript (JS)	A programming language that adds interactivity to websites — animations, button clicks, menus, and dynamic content.
Metadata	Information about your website that search engines and browsers read but users don't directly see — like page titles and descriptions.
Netlify	A free hosting platform that makes it extremely easy to publish websites with a drag-and-drop interface.
Node.js	A program that runs JavaScript on your computer (outside of a browser). Required to use npm and build React websites.
npm	Node Package Manager. A tool that downloads and manages the code libraries (packages) that your website needs to function.
Prompt	The text message you write to an AI to describe what you want it to create. The quality of your prompt determines the quality of the result.
React	A popular JavaScript framework for building modern websites. Made by Facebook. Manus AI typically builds React websites.
Repository (Repo)	A folder on GitHub that contains all your website's files and the history of changes.
Responsive Design	A website that automatically adjusts its layout to look good on all screen sizes — desktop, tablet, and mobile.
SEO (Search Engine Optimisation)	The practice of making your website rank higher in Google search results so more people find it.
Server	A powerful computer that stores website files and sends them to visitors' browsers when requested.
Sitemap	An XML file that lists all the pages on your website. Submitting it to Google Search Console helps Google find and index your pages.
SSL Certificate	A security certificate that encrypts data between your website and its visitors. Required for HTTPS. Netlify and Vercel provide this free.
Tailwind CSS	A popular CSS framework that makes it easy to style websites without writing custom CSS. Manus AI often uses Tailwind.
URL (Uniform Resource Locator)	The full web address of a specific page, e.g., https://www.yoursite.com/services .

Vercel	A free hosting platform optimised for React websites. Made by the same company as Next.js.
Vite	A fast build tool for modern web projects. Used to turn your React source code into the dist folder.
ZIP File	A compressed archive containing multiple files and folders. When you download your project from Manus AI, it comes as a ZIP file.

CHAPTER EXTRA

Essential Free Resources and Tools

Here is a curated list of the best free resources to help you continue learning and growing your website after this guide.

Free Learning Resources

freeCodeCamp.org

Completely free coding courses. Hundreds of hours of lessons on HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React and more. Certificate courses at no cost.

The Odin Project (theodinproject.com)

A free, open-source web development curriculum. Takes you from absolute beginner to job-ready. Community-driven and highly rated.

MDN Web Docs (developer.mozilla.org)

Mozilla's official web documentation. The most accurate and complete reference for HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. Bookmark this.

YouTube — Traversy Media

Brad Traversy creates clear, practical web development tutorials. Excellent for visual learners who want to see things done step by step.

YouTube — Kevin Powell

Kevin Powell focuses specifically on CSS and makes it approachable for beginners. His videos will fix most layout and styling problems.

Free Design Tools

Canva (canva.com)

Free graphic design tool. Create logos, social media graphics, banners, and images for your website. Thousands of templates available.

Unsplash (unsplash.com)

Free, high-quality stock photos. Every image is licensed for commercial use at no cost. Perfect for professional website imagery.

Pexels (pexels.com)

Another source of free stock photos and videos. Excellent quality and easy to search.

Google Fonts (fonts.google.com)

Hundreds of free professional fonts for your website. Browse here to choose specific typography for your brand.

Coolers (coolers.co)

Free colour palette generator. Generate matching colour schemes for your website from your brand colours.

Free SEO and Analytics Tools**Google Analytics**

Free tool that shows you how many people visit your website, where they come from, and what pages they view. Essential for growth.

Google Search Console

As covered in Chapter 11, shows you how Google sees your website and what search terms bring people to you.

GTmetrix (gtmetrix.com)

Free website speed testing. Enter your URL and get specific recommendations to make your site load faster.

Ubersuggest

Free keyword research. Find what words people type into Google when looking for services like yours.

CHAPTER PRO TIPS

Taking Your Skills to the Next Level

Once you have your first website live and working, here is how to continue growing from beginner toward professional web builder.

Learn the Fundamentals

You do not need to become a full developer to build better websites. But learning the basics of HTML and CSS gives you a massive advantage. When the AI makes a mistake, you will be able to spot and fix it. Set aside 30 minutes a day for 30 days working through HTML and CSS lessons on freeCodeCamp.org. By the end, you will understand 80% of what makes websites work.

Build a Portfolio of Your Work

Every website you build is a portfolio piece. Build 3 to 5 different types of websites: a business website, a personal blog, an events page, a portfolio site, and an online menu. Having a diverse portfolio opens doors to freelancing opportunities.

Start Freelancing

Once you can build a website in a day using AI tools, offer this as a service. Many local businesses have no website or have outdated ones. You can charge R2,000 to R8,000 to build a professional website for a local business in South Africa using the tools in this guide. Platforms like Fiverr.com and Upwork.com connect you with international clients.

Learn GitHub Properly

GitHub is the professional standard for managing website code. Learn these four commands and you will cover 90% of daily use: `git init` to start tracking a project, `git add` to stage changes, `git commit` to save a snapshot, and `git push` to upload to GitHub. The official Git documentation at git-scm.com is free and comprehensive.

Master Prompt Engineering

As AI tools become more powerful, knowing how to communicate with them effectively becomes increasingly valuable. Practice deliberately getting the AI to build specific features, then refine your prompts when results are not quite right. Build a personal library of prompts that you reuse and improve.

Build In Public

Share your progress publicly on social media as you build. Post before-and-after screenshots. Ask for feedback. Document what you learn. This accelerates your learning, builds your reputation, and can attract clients or opportunities. Many successful freelance web developers today started by simply sharing their learning journey online.

Keep Up With AI Tool Developments

The AI website building space moves extremely fast. New tools launch every month. Stay informed by following Product Hunt for new tool launches, the r/webdev community on Reddit, and the official blogs of Manus AI, Vercel, and Netlify. What is cutting-edge today may be standard practice next year.

Final Encouragement

- ✓ You now have a complete roadmap from zero to professional
- ✓ The tools are free — the only investment is your time
- ✓ Every expert was once a complete beginner
- ✓ Start today — your future clients are waiting
- ✓ Return to this guide whenever you get stuck

CHAPTER FAQ

Frequently Asked Questions From Beginners

These are the most common questions beginners ask when starting their website journey. Reading through these will save you hours of searching for answers later.

Q: Do I really need a website? I already have Instagram and Facebook.

A: Yes, you still need a website. Social media platforms own your profile — they can delete it, change the algorithm so no one sees your posts, or shut down entirely. Your website belongs to you permanently. It also gives your business credibility that social media alone cannot. Most importantly, your website can appear on Google search — something your Instagram profile cannot do nearly as effectively.

Q: How long will it take before my website appears on Google?

A: For brand new websites, expect 4 to 12 weeks before you start appearing in Google search results. This is normal and happens to every new website. To speed up the process, submit your site to Google Search Console (Chapter 11), make sure your site has real, useful content, and get at least one other website to link to yours.

Q: Is the free hosting really free forever?

A: Netlify, GitHub Pages, and Vercel all offer genuinely free hosting tiers that have existed for years and show no signs of going away. The free tiers have reasonable limits (bandwidth, build minutes) that most small business websites will never exceed. However, if your website becomes extremely popular or needs advanced features, you may eventually want to upgrade to a paid plan.

Q: What happens if the AI tool I use shuts down?

A: This is a real consideration. The important thing is that once you download your website files (Chapter 6), you own them completely. Even if Manus AI shut down tomorrow, your website files would still work. You could rebuild or update them using any other AI tool, or even manually. Always keep a downloaded backup of your website files.

Q: Can I build an online store where people can buy things?

A: Yes, but it is more complex than a simple business website. AI tools like Bolt.new and Lovable can build basic e-commerce features. For a serious online store, consider Shopify (paid, but the most reliable) or WooCommerce with WordPress. For South African businesses, PayFast is the most popular local payment gateway.

Q: My website looks great on desktop but bad on mobile. What do I do?

A: Go back to your AI tool and describe exactly what looks wrong on mobile. Be specific: 'On mobile phones, the text is too large and overflows off the screen', or 'The navigation menu is not working properly on mobile'. The AI will fix the responsive CSS. After fixing, test again by either using your phone to visit the site or by pressing F12 in Chrome and clicking the mobile device icon.

Q: Should I use www in my domain or not?

A: Both `www.yourdomain.com` and `yourdomain.com` (without `www`) will work. Most hosting platforms redirect one to the other automatically. The convention today is that both should work and lead to the same place. Netlify handles this automatically. When you print your domain on business cards or mention it verbally, you can just say 'yourdomain.com' without the `www`.

Q: How do I make my website secure?

A: The most important security step is using HTTPS (the padlock icon), which Netlify and Vercel enable for free automatically. For additional security: never include sensitive personal information (ID numbers, bank details) in your website files, make sure your hosting account has a strong, unique password, and enable two-factor authentication on your Netlify and GitHub accounts.

Q: Can I change my website design completely without losing my domain?

A: Yes. Your domain name is completely separate from your website design. You can completely rebuild your website and re-upload it to Netlify without changing your domain. Your visitors will just see the new design when they visit. This is actually recommended — redesigning your website every 2–3 years keeps it looking modern.

Q: Is it possible to make money from my website itself?

A: Yes, several ways. You can sell products or services directly through the website. You can add Google AdSense to display ads and earn per click. You can create a blog and use affiliate marketing links. You can offer premium content behind a paywall. You can use the website to attract clients for your offline business. The website itself is the asset — the income comes from how you use it.

Q: What is the difference between a website and a web app?

A: A website primarily displays information (text, images, videos). A web app is interactive — users can log in, create accounts, submit data, make purchases, or interact with a database. Your business website is a website. Gmail, Facebook, and online banking are web apps. The tools in this guide can build both, but web apps require more advanced setup.

Q: I built my website but no one is visiting. What should I do?

A: A website by itself does not attract visitors — you have to actively promote it. Add your URL to all social media profiles. Share it in relevant WhatsApp groups. Ask happy clients to visit and leave a Google review. Create content (blog posts) that people search for. Run Google Ads or Facebook Ads if you have budget. And keep working on SEO as described in Chapter 11. Building an audience takes time and consistent effort.

Congratulations!

You have reached the end of this guide. You now have everything you need to build, launch, and grow a professional website — completely free — using AI tools. Remember: the only way to learn is to start. Open Manus AI today and write your first prompt. Your website is waiting to be built.

You can do this.